

Trip Cooks — Content Management Guide

Your step-by-step guide to keeping the website up to date

Getting Started

The Trip Cooks website is connected to a content management system called **Contentful**. Think of it as the control panel for your website — you can add, edit, and update content here and it automatically appears on the live site within a minute.

To log in:

1. Go to app.contentful.com
2. Sign in with your account
3. Select the **tripcooks-website** space from your dashboard

Once inside, click **Content** in the top navigation bar. This is where all your content lives.

1. Updating an Existing Trip

Every trip you run is listed here. To make changes:

1. Click **Content** in the top menu
2. In the content type filter on the left, select **Trip**
3. Click on the trip you want to edit (e.g. "Montenegro 2024")

You will see all the fields for that trip. Here are the ones you can now update:

Group Size

This is the number of people on the trip. It appears on the featured trip card on the homepage.

- Find the **Group Size** field
 - Type the group range, for example: `12–18 people` or `8–12 people`
 - If you leave this empty, the website will show `12–18 people` as a default
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What's Not Included

This is the list of items that are **not** covered by the trip price (e.g. flights, breakfast). By default, the website always shows:

- Flight ticket
- Breakfast
- Airport pickup and transfer

If a specific trip has a **different** "not included" list, you can override it here. Click the **What's Not Included** field and add your custom items. If you leave it empty, the three defaults above will show automatically.

Tip: Only fill this in if the trip differs from the standard. Leave it empty for most trips.

Saving & Publishing

After making your changes:

1. Click the green **Publish** button in the top-right corner
2. The website will update within 60 seconds

If you want to save your work without it going live yet, click **Save** instead of **Publish**. You can come back and publish later.

2. Writing a Blog Post

Blog posts are the most important tool for growing Trip Cooks on Google. Each post you publish helps new customers find you.

Creating a New Post

1. Click **Content** in the top menu
2. Click the **Add entry** button (top right)
3. Select **Blog Post** from the list

You will see a form with the following fields:

Title The headline of your article. Make it clear and descriptive. *Example:* 5 Reasons Montenegro Should Be Your Next Group Trip

Slug This is the web address for the article. It is **auto-generated** from your title — you do not need to type it yourself. It will look like: 5-reasons-montenegro-should-be-your-next-group-trip

Do not change the slug once the post is published, as it will break any links people have saved.

Category Choose one of the following:

- **Travel updates** — destination guides, trip recaps, what to expect
 - **Company updates** — news about Trip Cooks, announcements
 - **Support** — booking help, FAQs, practical travel advice
 - **Stories from our community** — personal travel stories from your guests
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Author Your name or the name of whoever wrote the article. *Example:* The Trip Cooks Team or Amara Diallo

Date The publish date of the article. This is used to sort posts from newest to oldest.

Excerpt A short summary of the article (2–3 sentences). This appears on the blog listing page and in Google search results — make it compelling.

Cover Image The main photo for the article. Click **Add media**, then either upload a new photo or choose one from your media library.

Recommended size: At least 1200 × 630 pixels. Use a high-quality photo that represents the article topic.

Body This is the full article content. You can:

- Type and format text (bold, italic, headings)
- Add bullet points and numbered lists
- Insert images within the article

- Add quotes

The website automatically calculates how long the article takes to read and shows this to visitors.

Publishing Your Post

When you are happy with everything:

1. Click **Publish** in the top-right corner
 2. Your post will appear on the blog within 60 seconds
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3. Adding a Community Story

Community stories are the personal accounts from your travellers — their experiences, highlights, and memories from trips with Trip Cooks. These appear on the **Community** page.

Creating a New Story

1. Click **Content** in the top menu
2. Click **Add entry**
3. Select **Community Story**

Fill in the following fields:

Title The headline for this story. *Example:* How Montenegro Changed the Way I See Travel

Slug Auto-generated from the title. Leave it as is.

Author The traveller's name (with their permission). *Example:* Amara Diallo

Date The date the story was submitted or published.

Read Time How long the story takes to read. Type this manually. *Example:* 3 min read

Excerpt A short 2–3 sentence summary of the story. This is what visitors read on the community page before clicking through.

Image A photo from the traveller's trip. Upload it or choose from your media library.

Category Optional. You can tag the story with a category if needed.

Country The traveller's home country. *Example:* Nigeria or Ghana

Featured This is a simple **on/off toggle**. Turn it **on** for the 5 stories you want shown as photo cards at the top of the Community page (the hero section). Only mark up to 5 stories as featured at a time — the most recent 5 featured stories will be shown.

Tip: Choose featured stories from travellers with great photos and diverse countries — it makes the hero section look vibrant.

Publishing the Story

Click **Publish** when ready. It will appear on the community page within 60 seconds.

4. Updating Reviews

Reviews from your guests appear in the *"People actually really like us"* section on the community page and homepage.

To edit a review:

1. Go to **Content**
2. Filter by **Our Wall of Love**
3. Click on the review you want to update

You can now fill in two new fields:

Reviewer Name The first name (or full name) of the person who left the review. *Example:* Amara or Kezia M.

If you leave this blank, no name will be shown — the review will just display the quote and trip name.

Social Handle The reviewer's Instagram or TikTok handle (optional). If provided, it will appear below their name on the homepage review cards. *Example:* @amara.diallo

5. Quick Reference

What you want to do	Where to go in Contentful
Update a trip's group size or not-included items	Content → Trip → select the trip
Write a new blog article	Content → Add entry → Blog Post
Add a community traveller story	Content → Add entry → Community Story
Feature a traveller in the hero section	Community Story → turn on Featured toggle
Add a reviewer's name to a review	Content → Our Wall of Love → select the review
Add a social handle to a review	Content → Our Wall of Love → Social Handle field

Tips for Great Content

- **Publish blog posts regularly** — even one post per month makes a significant difference for Google ranking
 - **Use real photos** — images from actual trips perform far better than stock photography
 - **Write excerpts carefully** — they appear in Google search results and are often the reason someone clicks through
 - **Feature diverse travellers** — the community hero section represents your brand. Show a range of countries and backgrounds
 - **Keep titles clear** — visitors should know exactly what they're getting before they click
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For technical support or questions about the website, contact your web developer.